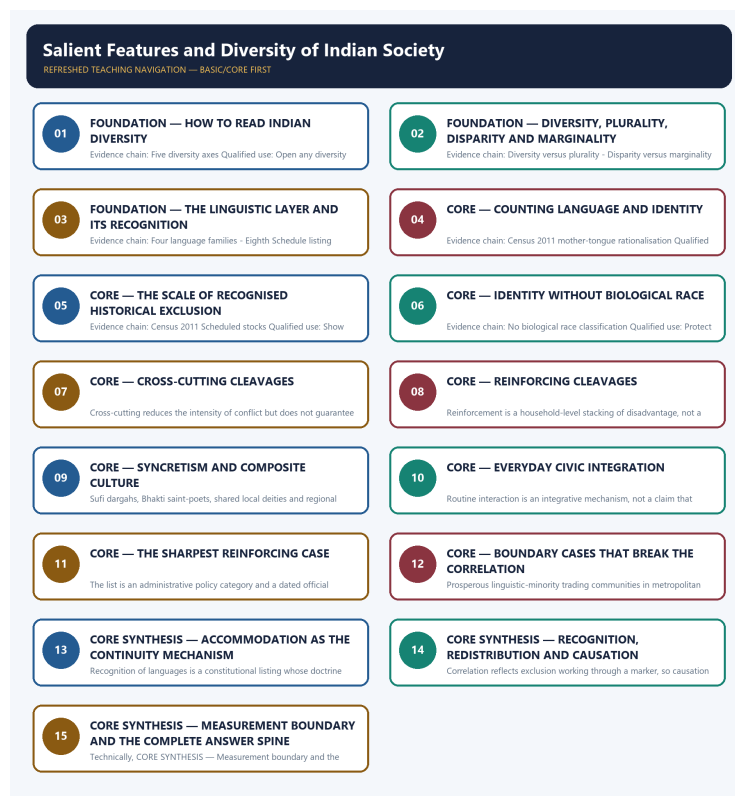


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Salient Features and Diversity of Indian Society - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Five diversity axes?

A. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. B. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. C. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. D. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance.

Answer: A. Explanation: Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Five diversity axes?

A. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. B. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. C. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. D. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Five diversity axes?

A. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. B. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. C. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. D. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Five diversity axes?

A. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. B. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. C. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. D. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Diversity versus plurality?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. B. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. C. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. D. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference.

Answer: A. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Diversity versus plurality?

A. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. B. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. C. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. D. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language.

Answer: B. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Diversity versus plurality?

A. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. B. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. C. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. D. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Diversity versus plurality?

A. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. B. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. C. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. D. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance.

Answer: D. Explanation: Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Disparity versus marginality?

A. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. B. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. C. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. D. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth.

Answer: A. Explanation: Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Disparity versus marginality?

A. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. B. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. C. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. D. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Disparity versus marginality?

A. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. B. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. C. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. D. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Disparity versus marginality?

A. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. B. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. C. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. D. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference.

Answer: D. Explanation: Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Four language families?

A. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. B. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. C. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. D. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Four language families?

A. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. B. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. C. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. D. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four language families?

A. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. B. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. C. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. D. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four language families?

A. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. B. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. C. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. D. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Eighth Schedule listing?

A. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. B. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. C. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. D. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Eighth Schedule listing?

A. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. B. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. C. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. D. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Eighth Schedule listing?

A. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. B. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. C. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. D. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Eighth Schedule listing?

A. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. B. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. C. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. D. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Census 2011 mother-tongue rationalisation?

A. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. B. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. C. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. D. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Census 2011 mother-tongue rationalisation?

A. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. B. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. C. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. D. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong.

Answer: B. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Census 2011 mother-tongue rationalisation?

A. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. B. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. C. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. D. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region.

Answer: C. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Census 2011 mother-tongue rationalisation?

A. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. B. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. C. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. D. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth.

Answer: D. Explanation: Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Census 2011 Scheduled stocks?

A. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. B. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. C. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. D. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong.

Answer: A. Explanation: At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Census 2011 Scheduled stocks?

A. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. B. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. C. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. D. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong.

Answer: B. Explanation: At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Census 2011 Scheduled stocks?

A. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. B. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. C. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. D. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.

Answer: C. Explanation: At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Census 2011 Scheduled stocks?

A. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. B. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. C. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. D. At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies No biological race classification?

A. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. B. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. C. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. D. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense.

Answer: A. Explanation: Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under No biological race classification?

A. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. B. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. C. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. D. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.

Answer: B. Explanation: Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of No biological race classification?

A. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. B. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. C. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. D. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.

Answer: C. Explanation: Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about No biological race classification?

A. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. B. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. C. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. D. Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead.

Answer: D. Explanation: Older physical-anthropology labels are not a sound description of contemporary Indian society, and official Census operations do not classify Indians into biological races; self-identification, language, culture and regional history are used instead. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Cross-cutting cleavage?

A. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. B. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. C. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. D. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region.

Answer: A. Explanation: Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Cross-cutting cleavage?

A. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. B. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. C. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. D. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Cross-cutting cleavage?

A. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. B. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. C. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. D. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.

Answer: C. Explanation: Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Cross-cutting cleavage?

A. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. D. Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense.

Answer: D. Explanation: Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Reinforcing cleavage?

A. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. B. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. C. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. D. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Reinforcing cleavage?

A. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. B. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. C. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. D. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Reinforcing cleavage?

A. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. B. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. C. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. D. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Reinforcing cleavage?

A. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. D. Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong.

Answer: D. Explanation: Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Syncretic integrative traditions?

A. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. B. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. C. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. D. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Syncretic integrative traditions?

A. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. B. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. C. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. D. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Syncretic integrative traditions?

A. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. D. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Syncretic integrative traditions?

A. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. D. Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Everyday civic integration?

A. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. D. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Everyday civic integration?

A. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. B. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. C. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. D. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric.

Answer: B. Explanation: Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Everyday civic integration?

A. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. D. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact.

Answer: C. Explanation: Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Everyday civic integration?

A. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. B. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. C. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. D. Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.

Answer: D. Explanation: Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups?

A. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. B. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. C. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. D. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups?

A. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. B. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. C. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. D. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups?

A. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. B. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. C. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. D. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups?

A. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. B. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. C. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. D. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Diversity without marginality?

A. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. B. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. C. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. D. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood.

Answer: A. Explanation: Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Diversity without marginality?

A. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. B. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. C. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. D. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood.

Answer: B. Explanation: Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Diversity without marginality?

A. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. B. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. C. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. D. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Diversity without marginality?

A. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. B. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. D. Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Marginality without a cultural marker?

A. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. B. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. C. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. D. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact.

Answer: A. Explanation: A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Marginality without a cultural marker?

A. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. B. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. C. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. D. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration.

Answer: B. Explanation: A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Marginality without a cultural marker?

A. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. B. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. C. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words.

Answer: C. Explanation: A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Marginality without a cultural marker?

A. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. B. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. D. A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric.

Answer: D. Explanation: A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Accommodation as the continuity mechanism?

A. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. B. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. C. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. D. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration.

Answer: A. Explanation: Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Accommodation as the continuity mechanism?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. B. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. C. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. D. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Accommodation as the continuity mechanism?

A. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. B. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. C. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Accommodation as the continuity mechanism?

A. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. B. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. D. Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Recognition versus redistribution?

A. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. C. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. D. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration.

Answer: A. Explanation: Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Recognition versus redistribution?

A. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. B. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. D. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Answer: B. Explanation: Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Recognition versus redistribution?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. B. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. C. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. D. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Recognition versus redistribution?

A. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. B. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. C. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. D. Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact.

Answer: D. Explanation: Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Correlation is not causation?

A. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. B. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. C. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words.

Answer: A. Explanation: Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Correlation is not causation?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. B. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. C. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. D. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Answer: B. Explanation: Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Correlation is not causation?

A. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. B. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. C. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. D. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Correlation is not causation?

A. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. B. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. C. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. D. Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Census 2027 measurement boundary?

A. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. C. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. D. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance.

Answer: A. Explanation: Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Census 2027 measurement boundary?

A. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. B. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. C. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. D. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference.

Answer: B. Explanation: Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Census 2027 measurement boundary?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. B. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. C. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. D. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language.

Answer: C. Explanation: Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Census 2027 measurement boundary?

A. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. B. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. C. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. D. Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration.

Answer: D. Explanation: Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective,

yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. B. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. C. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. D. Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Answer: A. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. B. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. C. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. D. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language.

Answer: B. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. B. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. C. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. D. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. B. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages; the constitutional doctrine of that listing belongs to Polity and is cited here only as recognition evidence. C. Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. D. Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words.

Answer: D. Explanation: Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner from the audited routing ledgers and confirmed word for word in the locally held official question papers: 2024 GS-I Q20 and 2019 GS-I Q8. The 2019 demand is routed in the ledger to the Advanced owner while the Core owner records that Core routing supersedes it; both are therefore answered here from the Basic spine. The generated 2018-2023 Prelims block additionally routes two 2023 objective items on national sports awards and the Chess Olympiad mascot and trophies. Those are documented current-affairs routing artefacts with no Indian Society content, their official keys are not held locally, and this package neither claims them nor infers an option for them.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I PYQ (15 marks):** "Critically analyse the proposition that there is a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities." The expected answer: (a) state the proposition - cultural difference often coincides with deprivation (tribal areas, some religious-minority-concentration districts, certain caste groups); (b) critically test it - many diverse groups are prosperous (Parsis, several Sikh and Jain trading communities, dominant landholding castes), showing the correlation is conditional, not universal; (c) conclude that the causal driver is *historical exclusion and geographic remoteness*, not diversity itself, so policy must target the exclusion mechanism rather than treat diversity as inherently disadvantaging.

- **ANALYSIS:** A linguistic-minority trader community that is economically prosperous illustrates diversity without marginality; a remote Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group illustrates diversity compounding into marginality through geographic and infrastructural exclusion.

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (15 marks):** structure as proposition -> critical test with counter-examples
-> causal reframing (exclusion/remoteness, not diversity per se) -> policy implication (target the exclusion mechanism, not the identity marker).

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-I	20	Correlation between cultural diversity and socio-economic marginalities	Critically analyse · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Correlation between cultural diversity and socio-economic marginalities

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Prelims GS-I	95	National sports awards Khel Ratna Arjuna Dronacharya criteria	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	96	Chess Olympiad 2022 India mascot Thambi trophies	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- National sports awards Khel Ratna Arjuna Dronacharya criteria
- Chess Olympiad 2022 India mascot Thambi trophies

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2024 GS-I (15 marks, verbatim):** "Critically analyse the proposition that there is a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities." Analytical route: (a) state the correlation with named examples (PVTGs, some minority-concentration districts); (b) apply the cross-cutting/reinforcing framework to show the correlation is conditional; (c) invoke the recognition-redistribution distinction to argue that policy responses must match the actual gap (resource versus respect); (d) conclude that diversity is a marker, not a cause, of marginality, so the proposition should be accepted only where cleavages reinforce, not as a universal law.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019

- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-I	8	What makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- What makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q20

Demand: Critically analyse the proposition that there is a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks.

Status: Verified verbatim in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I.

Model solution: Open by stating the proposition exactly as an analytical claim to be tested rather than restated, and separate diversity as a fact from marginality as an outcome. Show where it holds: the Ministry of Tribal Affairs list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, whose legacy criteria of pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy stack identity distinctiveness, remoteness and asset-poverty on one population, which proves the reinforcing-cleavage case; the qualification is that these are administrative criteria and conditions vary by State. Show where it fails: prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities and several Sikh and Jain business communities are culturally distinct and economically integrated, while a landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste is deprived without a distinct cultural marker, which proves the correlation is neither universal nor symmetric; the qualification is that both are group-level illustrations carrying no invented income figure. Reframe causally: historical exclusion and geographic remoteness are the mechanism and diversity is the visible marker, so policy that manages identity while leaving exclusion intact reproduces the pattern it claims to address. Add the measurement caution that Census 2011 recorded Scheduled Tribes at about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes at about 16.6 per cent as a stock, that national aggregates mask which sub-group is reinforced-marginal, and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced by the Press Information Bureau on 30 April 2025 with reference dates fixed by Gazette S.O. 2681(E) is prospective and yields no figure. Conclude with a conditional verdict: accept the proposition where cleavages reinforce, reject it as a law of Indian society, and target the exclusion mechanism rather than the identity marker. Why this earns marks: it tests the proposition instead of restating it, supplies dated named evidence on both sides, reframes correlation as marker rather than mechanism, and closes with a graded, policy-relevant verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q20", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Open by stating the proposition exactly as an analytical claim to be tested rather than restated, and separate diversity as a fact from marginality as an outcome. Show where it holds: the Ministry of Tribal Affairs list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, whose legacy criteria of pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy stack identity distinctiveness, remoteness and asset-poverty on one population, which proves the reinforcing-cleavage case; the qualification is that these are administrative criteria and conditions vary by State. Show where it fails: prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities and several Sikh and Jain

business communities are culturally distinct and economically integrated, while a landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste is deprived without a distinct cultural marker, which proves the correlation is neither universal nor symmetric; the qualification is that both are group-level illustrations carrying no invented income figure. Reframe causally: historical exclusion and geographic remoteness are the mechanism and diversity is the visible marker, so policy that manages identity while leaving exclusion intact reproduces the pattern it claims to address. Add the measurement caution that Census 2011 recorded Scheduled Tribes at about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes at about 16.6 per cent as a stock, that national aggregates mask which sub-group is reinforced-marginal, and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced by the Press Information Bureau on 30 April 2025 with reference dates fixed by Gazette S.O. 2681(E) is prospective and yields no figure. Conclude with a conditional verdict: accept the proposition where cleavages reinforce, reject it as a law of Indian society, and target the exclusion mechanism rather than the identity marker. Why this earns marks: it tests the proposition instead of restating it, supplies dated named evidence on both sides, reframes correlation as marker rather than mechanism, and closes with a graded, policy-relevant verdict.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Critically analyse the proposition that there is a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities. (Answer in 250 words) 15 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified verbatim in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Open by stating the proposition exactly as an analytical claim to be tested rather than restated, and separate diversity as a fact from marginality as an outcome. Show where it holds: the Ministry of Tribal Affairs list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, whose legacy criteria of pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy stack identity distinctiveness, remoteness and asset-poverty on one population, which proves the reinforcing-cleavage case; the qualification is that these are administrative criteria and conditions vary by State. Show where it fails: prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities and several Sikh and Jain business communities are culturally distinct and economically integrated, while a landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste is deprived without a distinct cultural marker, which proves the correlation is neither universal nor symmetric; the qualification is that both are group-level illustrations carrying no invented income figure. Reframe causally: historical exclusion and geographic remoteness are the mechanism and diversity is the visible marker, so policy that manages identity while leaving exclusion intact reproduces the pattern it claims to address. Add the measurement caution that Census 2011 recorded Scheduled Tribes at about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes at about 16.6 per cent as a stock, that national aggregates mask which sub-group is reinforced-marginal, and that the Census 2027 caste enumeration announced by the Press Information Bureau on 30 April 2025 with reference dates fixed by Gazette S.O. 2681(E) is prospective and yields no figure. Conclude with a conditional verdict: accept the proposition where cleavages reinforce, reject it as a law of Indian society, and target the exclusion mechanism rather than the identity marker. Why this earns marks: it tests the proposition instead of restating it, supplies dated named evidence on both sides, reframes correlation as marker rather than mechanism, and closes with a graded, policy-relevant verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 GS-I Q20", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-I Q8

Demand: What makes the Indian society unique in sustaining its culture? Discuss. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Verified verbatim in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and in the locally held official General Studies Paper-I. The ledger routes it to the Advanced owner; the Core owner records that Core routing supersedes, so it is answered from the Basic spine.

Model solution: Open with the mechanism thesis that Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption rather than insulation. Give the layering evidence: ethnic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes coexisted instead of one replacing another, and Census 2011 rationalised over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which proves depth was retained rather than flattened; the qualification is that a rationalised count is a measurement decision. Give the transmission evidence: family and jati socialisation, ritual calendars and festival circuits such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal, and syncretic idioms including Sufi dargahs and Bhakti saint-poetry, which proves continuity was carried by decentralised institutions rather than a central authority. Give the institutional evidence: recognition through the Eighth Schedule listing of 22 languages and territorial accommodation through the States Reorganisation Act, 1956, which proves that assertion was absorbed into governance instead of being suppressed. Qualify honestly that continuity is not uniformity, because hierarchy and exclusion persisted inside the same transmitting institutions. Conclude that uniqueness lies in the capacity to add without extinguishing, which is also why inequality endured alongside continuity. Why this earns marks: it answers the directive with named mechanisms and dated evidence, avoids adjectival celebration, and supplies a qualification that converts description into analysis.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-I Q8", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Open with the mechanism thesis that Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption rather than insulation. Give the layering evidence: ethnic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes coexisted instead of one replacing another, and Census 2011 rationalised over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which proves depth was retained rather than flattened; the qualification is that a rationalised count is a measurement decision. Give the transmission evidence: family and jati socialisation, ritual calendars and festival circuits such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal, and syncretic idioms including Sufi dargahs and Bhakti saint-poetry, which proves continuity was carried by decentralised institutions rather than a central authority. Give the institutional evidence: recognition through the Eighth Schedule listing of 22 languages and territorial accommodation through the States Reorganisation Act, 1956, which proves that assertion was absorbed into governance instead of being suppressed. Qualify honestly that continuity is not uniformity, because hierarchy and exclusion persisted inside the same transmitting institutions. Conclude that uniqueness lies in the capacity to add without extinguishing, which is also why inequality endured alongside continuity. Why this earns marks: it answers the directive with named mechanisms and dated evidence, avoids adjectival celebration, and supplies a qualification that converts description into analysis.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: What makes the Indian society unique in sustaining its culture? Discuss. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Open with the mechanism thesis that Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption rather than insulation. Give the layering evidence: ethnic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes coexisted instead of one replacing another, and Census 2011 rationalised over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which proves depth was retained rather than flattened; the qualification is that a rationalised count is a measurement decision. Give the transmission evidence: family and jati socialisation, ritual calendars and festival circuits such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal, and syncretic idioms including Sufi dargahs and Bhakti saint-poetry, which proves continuity was carried by decentralised institutions rather than a central authority. Give the institutional evidence: recognition through the Eighth Schedule listing of 22 languages and territorial accommodation through the States Reorganisation Act, 1956, which proves that assertion was absorbed into governance instead of being suppressed. Qualify honestly that continuity is not uniformity, because hierarchy and exclusion persisted inside the same transmitting institutions. Conclude that uniqueness lies in the capacity to add without extinguishing, which is also why inequality endured alongside continuity. Why this earns marks: it answers the directive with named mechanisms and dated evidence, avoids adjectival celebration, and supplies a qualification that converts description into analysis.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-I Q8", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Discuss what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, carried by decentralised transmission and syncretic idioms, while hierarchy survived inside the same continuity.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.
- Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region.
- Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.
- Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood.
- Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language.
- Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth.

Qualified conclusion: Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, carried by decentralised transmission and syncretic idioms, while hierarchy survived inside the same continuity.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture. Answer in about 150 words.", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, carried by decentralised transmission and syncretic idioms, while hierarchy survived inside the same continuity.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian cultural continuity worked through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, illustrated by the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodating linguistic assertion through statehood. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four large language families commonly used in UPSC texts, and that shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy of every Indian language. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Indian culture persisted through accommodative absorption and institutional recognition rather than insulation, carried by decentralised transmission and syncretic idioms, while hierarchy survived inside the same continuity.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish diversity, plurality, disparity and marginality using Indian examples. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The four terms separate the fact of difference, the quality of coexistence, the inequality of outcomes and the condition of exclusion, and confusing them produces the commonest answer error in this topic.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance.
- Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference.

Qualified conclusion: The four terms separate the fact of difference, the quality of coexistence, the inequality of outcomes and the condition of exclusion, and confusing them produces the commonest answer error in this topic.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish diversity, plurality, disparity and marginality using Indian examples. Answer in...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The four terms separate the fact of difference, the quality of coexistence, the inequality of outcomes and the condition of exclusion, and confusing them produces the commonest answer error in this topic.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Disparity is unequal development outcomes between groups or regions, while marginality is exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice; neither follows automatically from the fact of difference. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The four terms separate the fact of difference, the quality of coexistence, the inequality of outcomes and the condition of exclusion, and confusing them produces the commonest answer error in this topic.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish diversity, plurality, disparity and marginality using Indian examples. Answer in...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Cultural diversity in India marks disadvantage but does not produce it. Critically examine. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Diversity correlates with deprivation only where identity axes reinforce historical exclusion and geographic remoteness; where they cross-cut, diversity coexists with prosperity, so exclusion rather than difference is the mechanism.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense.
- Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong.
- The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.
- Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation.
- A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric.
- Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.

Qualified conclusion: Diversity correlates with deprivation only where identity axes reinforce historical exclusion and geographic remoteness; where they cross-cut, diversity coexists with prosperity, so exclusion rather than difference is the mechanism.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Cultural diversity in India marks disadvantage but does not produce it. Critically examine....", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Diversity correlates with deprivation only where identity axes reinforce historical exclusion and geographic remoteness; where they cross-cut, diversity coexists with prosperity, so exclusion rather than difference is the mechanism.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Prosperous linguistic-minority trading communities in metropolitan India and several Sikh and Jain business communities show that cultural distinctiveness does not by itself predict deprivation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** A landless labouring household of the locally dominant caste in a poor region shows class-based deprivation operating without a distinct cultural marker, so the correlation is not symmetric. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Diversity correlates with deprivation only where identity axes reinforce historical exclusion and geographic remoteness; where they cross-cut, diversity coexists with prosperity, so exclusion rather than difference is the mechanism.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Cultural diversity in India marks disadvantage but does not produce it. Critically examine....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine how cross-cutting identities help India manage cultural diversity without permanent conflict. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Cross-cutting cleavages prevent any single identity from predicting every disadvantage, and integrative civic and syncretic institutions convert difference into routine interaction rather than standing grievance.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense.
- Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region.
- Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods.
- Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other.

Qualified conclusion: Cross-cutting cleavages prevent any single identity from predicting every disadvantage, and integrative civic and syncretic institutions convert difference into routine interaction rather than standing grievance.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine how cross-cutting identities help India manage cultural diversity without permanent...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Cross-cutting cleavages prevent any single identity from predicting every disadvantage, and integrative civic and syncretic institutions convert difference into routine interaction rather than standing grievance.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Where identity axes do not align, disadvantage on one axis is often offset on another, so no single identity always predicts deprivation and group conflict is less intense. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Sufi dargahs, Bhakti saint-poets, shared local deities and regional festivals such as Onam, Bihu and Pongal create composite belonging that crosses religion and region. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Common schools, markets, elections and public transport work as routine integrative spaces in which diverse groups interact, and internal migration for work normalises mixed neighbourhoods. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian diversity runs along ethnic or ethno-linguistic, linguistic, religious, regional and caste-tribe axes that are layered and overlapping rather than parallel, so cohesion depends on whether the axes reinforce each other or cut across each other. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Cross-cutting cleavages prevent any single identity from predicting every disadvantage, and integrative civic and syncretic institutions convert difference into routine interaction rather than standing grievance.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine how cross-cutting identities help India manage cultural diversity without permanent...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess diversity, plurality and cohesion in India as an integrated problem of recognition and redistribution. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Cohesion depends less on the volume of difference than on whether recognition and redistribution are matched to the actual gap, because recognition alone leaves reinforcing deprivation intact and redistribution alone leaves identity grievance unaddressed.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance.
- Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong.
- Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact.
- Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.
- The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy.

Qualified conclusion: Cohesion depends less on the volume of difference than on whether recognition and redistribution are matched to the actual gap, because recognition alone leaves reinforcing deprivation intact and redistribution alone leaves identity grievance unaddressed.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess diversity, plurality and cohesion in India as an integrated problem of recognition and...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Cohesion depends less on the volume of difference than on whether recognition and redistribution are matched to the actual gap, because recognition alone leaves reinforcing deprivation intact and redistribution alone leaves identity grievance unaddressed.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Diversity is the objective presence of different identities, while plurality is coexistence with mutual recognition, so a headcount of difference is not by itself evidence of acceptance. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Where remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty and minority status stack on the same household, ordinary diversity compounds into marginality and the correlation the examiner asks about becomes strong. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Recognition addresses disrespect for identity and culture while redistribution addresses unequal resources and opportunity, so a response that supplies only symbolic recognition leaves an access or asset gap intact. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope,

correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list dated 9 July 2024 identifies 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in 18 States and the Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, with legacy criteria including pre-agricultural technology, low literacy, stagnant or declining population and subsistence economy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Cohesion depends less on the volume of difference than on whether recognition and redistribution are matched to the actual gap, because recognition alone leaves reinforcing deprivation intact and redistribution alone leaves identity grievance unaddressed.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess diversity, plurality and cohesion in India as an integrated problem of recognition and...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the statistical and evidentiary limits of any claim that Indian diversity causes socio-economic marginality. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The claim is limited by aggregation masking, by the absence of an all-India caste count and by the stock nature of Census 2011, so an honest answer states the measurement gap as part of the argument.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions.
- Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration.
- Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words.
- Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it.
- Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth.

Qualified conclusion: The claim is limited by aggregation masking, by the absence of an all-India caste count and by the stock nature of Census 2011, so an honest answer states the measurement gap as part of the argument.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate the statistical and evidentiary limits of any claim that Indian diversity causes...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The claim is limited by aggregation masking, by the absence of an all-India caste count and by the stock nature of Census 2011, so an honest answer states the measurement gap as part of the argument.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** At Census 2011, the last completed full count, Scheduled Tribes were about 8.6 per cent and Scheduled Castes about 16.6 per cent of the population, so diversity questions are also distribution questions. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Gazette S.O. 2681(E) dated 16 June 2025 fixes Census 2027 reference dates at 1 October 2026 for Ladakh and specified snow-bound areas and 1 March 2027 elsewhere, and the Press Information Bureau announcement of 30 April 2025 confirms caste enumeration; the exercise is prospective, yields no figure to quote and is not India's first historical caste enumeration. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Two direct General Studies Paper-I demands are verified for this owner: the 2024 question requiring a critical analysis of the proposition of a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities in 250 words, and the 2019 question asking what makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture in 150 words. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Historical exclusion, geographic remoteness and asset-poverty are the causal drivers of deprivation, and cultural diversity is usually the visible marker rather than the mechanism that produces it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Census 2011 recorded over 19,500 raw mother-tongue returns, rationalised into 121 languages spoken by 10,000 or more persons, which fixes the scale of linguistic depth. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The claim is limited by aggregation masking, by the absence of an all-India caste count and by the stock nature of Census 2011, so an honest answer states the measurement gap as part of the argument.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the statistical and evidentiary limits of any claim that Indian diversity causes...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.